

PopupMenuButton Documentation (Flutter)

This document explains how to use `PopupMenuButton<String>` as an **alternative to DropdownButton**. It is simple, flexible, and easy to reuse later.

Purpose

`PopupMenuButton` allows the user to: - Tap a button - Open a menu with options - Select one value from a list

It works like a **custom dropdown**, but gives you **full UI control**.

UI Code (PopupMenuButton)

```
PopupMenuButton<String>(  
  onSelect: (value) {  
    setState(() {  
      selectedItem = value;  
    });  
  },  
  itemBuilder: (context) => items  
    .map(  
      (item) => PopupMenuItem<String>(  
        value: item,  
        child: Text(item),  
      ),  
    )  
    .toList(),  
  child: Container(  
    padding: EdgeInsets.symmetric(horizontal: 16, vertical: 12),  
    decoration: BoxDecoration(  
      border: Border.all(color: Colors.grey),  
      borderRadius: BorderRadius.circular(12),  
    ),  
    child: Text(selectedItem ?? 'Select item'),  
  ),  
)
```

Required Variables

You need only these two variables:

```
List<String> items = ["item1", "item2", "item3"];  
String? selectedItem;
```

Code Explanation (Section by Section)

PopupMenuButton

```
PopupMenuButton<String>(...)
```

- `<String>` means the selected value type is `String`

onSelected

```
onSelected: (value) {  
  setState(() {  
    selectedItem = value;  
  });  
},
```

- Called when the user selects an item
- Saves the selected value
- `setState()` updates the UI

itemBuilder

```
itemBuilder: (context) => items.map(...).toList(),
```

- Converts the list into menu items
- Each `PopupMenuItem` represents one option

```
PopupMenuItem(  
  value: item,
```

```
    child: Text(item),  
  )
```

child (Button UI)

```
child: Container(...)
```

This is the **visible button** that the user taps.

Inside it: - **padding** → space inside button - **decoration** → border + rounded corners - **Text** → shows selected value or placeholder

Placeholder Text

```
Text(selectedItem ?? 'Select item')
```

- Shows selected item if available
- Otherwise shows "**Select item**"

Customization Ideas

Change Border Color

```
Border.all(color: Colors.blue)
```

Add Icon

```
Row(  
  mainAxisAlignment: MainAxisAlignment.min,  
  children: [  
    Text(selectedItem ?? 'Select item'),  
    Icon(Icons.arrow_drop_down),  
  ],  
)
```

Change Menu Position

```
position: PopupMenuPosition.under,
```

When to Use PopupMenuButton

✓ Custom button design needed ✓ Dropdown look not required ✓ Clean & lightweight ✓ Works great in AppBar and forms



PopupMenuButton vs DropdownButton

Feature	PopupMenuButton	DropdownButton
Custom UI	✓ Yes	✗ Limited
Form Field	✗ No	✓ Yes
Modern Look	✓ Yes	⚠ Normal

Summary

- `PopupMenuButton` is a powerful dropdown alternative
- Gives full control over UI
- Easy to understand and reuse

If you want: - Stateless version - Bangla explanation - PDF documentation - Reusable widget

Tell me ♀